CHAPTER 6

Adding a Database: Postgres

I don't know about you, but I'm feeling great about our progress. We've gradually been leveling up our skills and are now within touching distance of our Dockerized Rails app having all the capabilities we're used to when running Rails locally.

However, there's still one glaring omission: we haven't set up a database. The vast majority of Rails applications require some persistent storage.

In this chapter, we'll rectify that, building on our experience of adding the Redis server, to connect a Postgres database.

While reading this chapter, remember to keep the bigger picture in mind. The skills you're learning apply to *any* services you might want to add to your app, be it running background jobs (such as Sidekiq), Elasticsearch, or a JavaScript front end for a Rails API.

Starting a Postgres Server

We want to run a Postgres server for our Rails app to use. The process is very similar to how we added Redis.

In the previous chapter, we started by familiarizing ourselves with how to run the Redis server with `docker run`. However, now that we've had some experience with adding a service, let's take the safety wheels off and jump straight to setting up Postgres directly with Compose.

Let's add Postgres to our `docker-compose.yml` file: